

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE – 21

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

PART - 1

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

SANGAM AGE

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

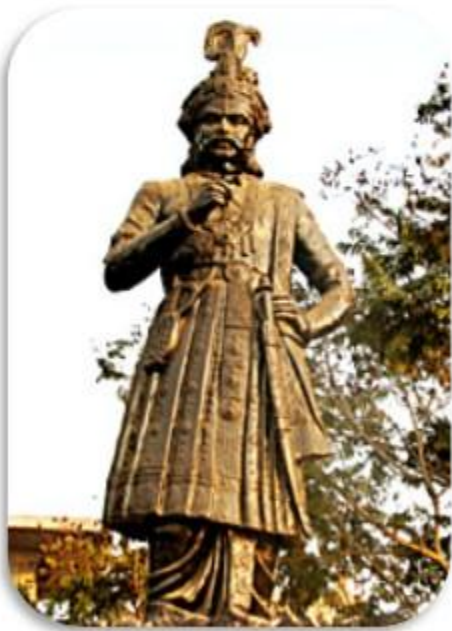
(590 AD TO 647 AD)

WHO WERE PUSHYABHUTIS

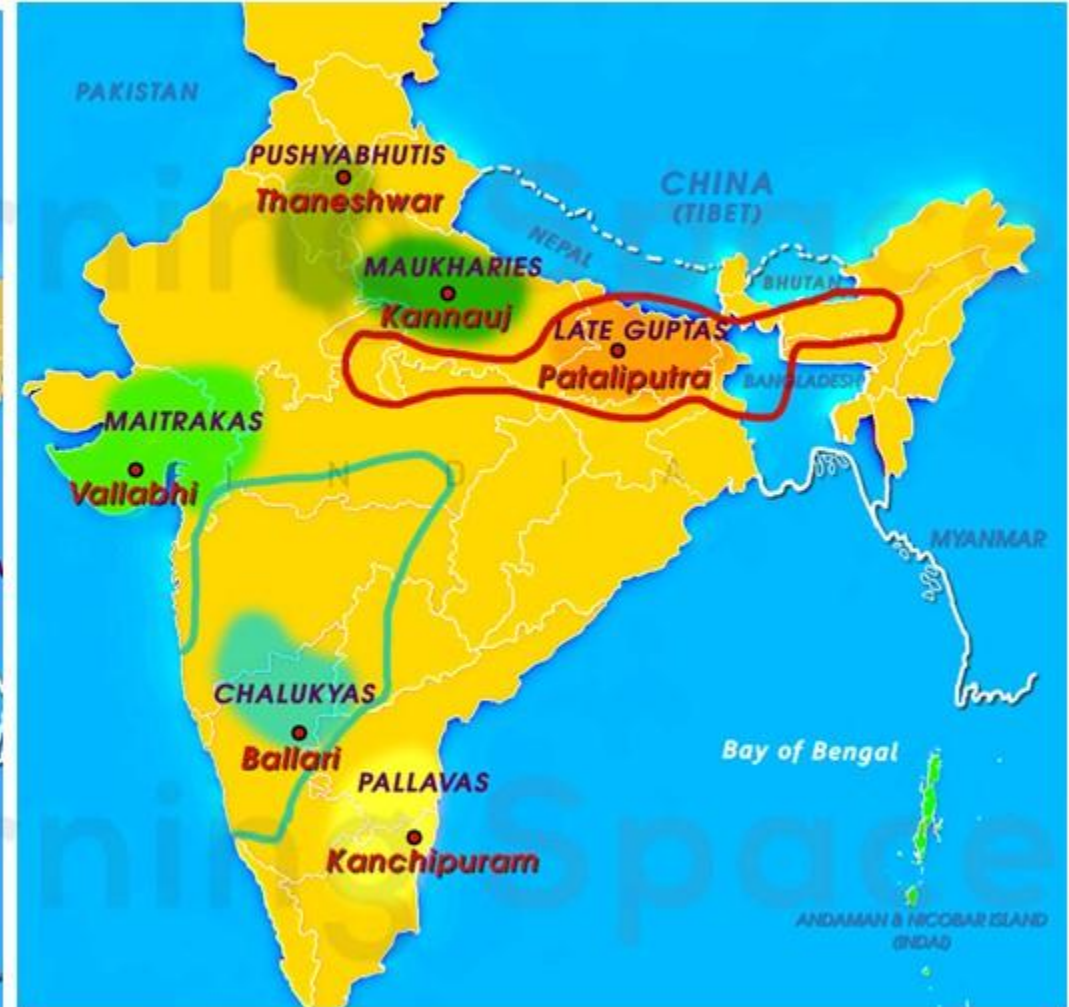
1 Pushyabhutis were feudatories of Gupta.

2 Decline of the Gupta Empire resulted in the splitting of northern India into several kingdoms

3 An important ruling family that gain prominence after the fall of the Gupta was that of the Pushyabhutis, who had their capital at Thanesar



INTRODUCTION



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THE SOURCES OF PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

ARCHAEOLOGICAL

LITERARY

RELIGIOUS

SECULAR

▪ Buddhist scripture -

TRAVELLER'S MEMORIES

Hieun tsang- Si-yu-ki
(record of western countries)

PLAYS / DRAMAS / POEMS

- Banabhata-
Harshacharita
- Harshavardhan
drama-
 - Priyadarshika
 - Nagananda
 - Ratnavali

COINS (Numismatics)



MONUMENTS TEMPLES



ARTIFACTS & OBJECTS



INSCRIPTIONS AND EDICTS

- Madhuben inscription
- Sonpat inscription
- Banshekra inscription

OTHERS

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(590 AD TO 647 AD)

PROMINENT KINGS

590 AD

PUSHYABHUTI

He was the founder. Taking advantage of political turmoil created after Huns invasion he declared independence. They were called as Vardhanas.

PRABHAKARVARDHAN

First important king. He assumed the title Maharajadhiraja and Paramabhataraka.

RAJYAVARDHAN

Elder son of Prabhakarvardhana, brother of Harshavardhana

647 AD

HARSHAVARDHAN

Most important king of this dynasty. He is known as the last great Hindu king of India

HOW HARSHAVARDHAN ROSE TO POWER?

1

After Prabhakaravardhana's death, his elder son Rajyavardhana came to the throne.



2

His sister, **Rajyasri** had married the **Maukhari ruler** called Grihavarman.



3

The **ruler of Malwa**, Devagupta (one remnant of Guptas) in league with Sasanka, the **ruler of Bengal** had killed Grihavarman.

4

On hearing this news, **Rajyavardhana** marched against the king of Malwa. But he was **murdered by Sasanka**.

5

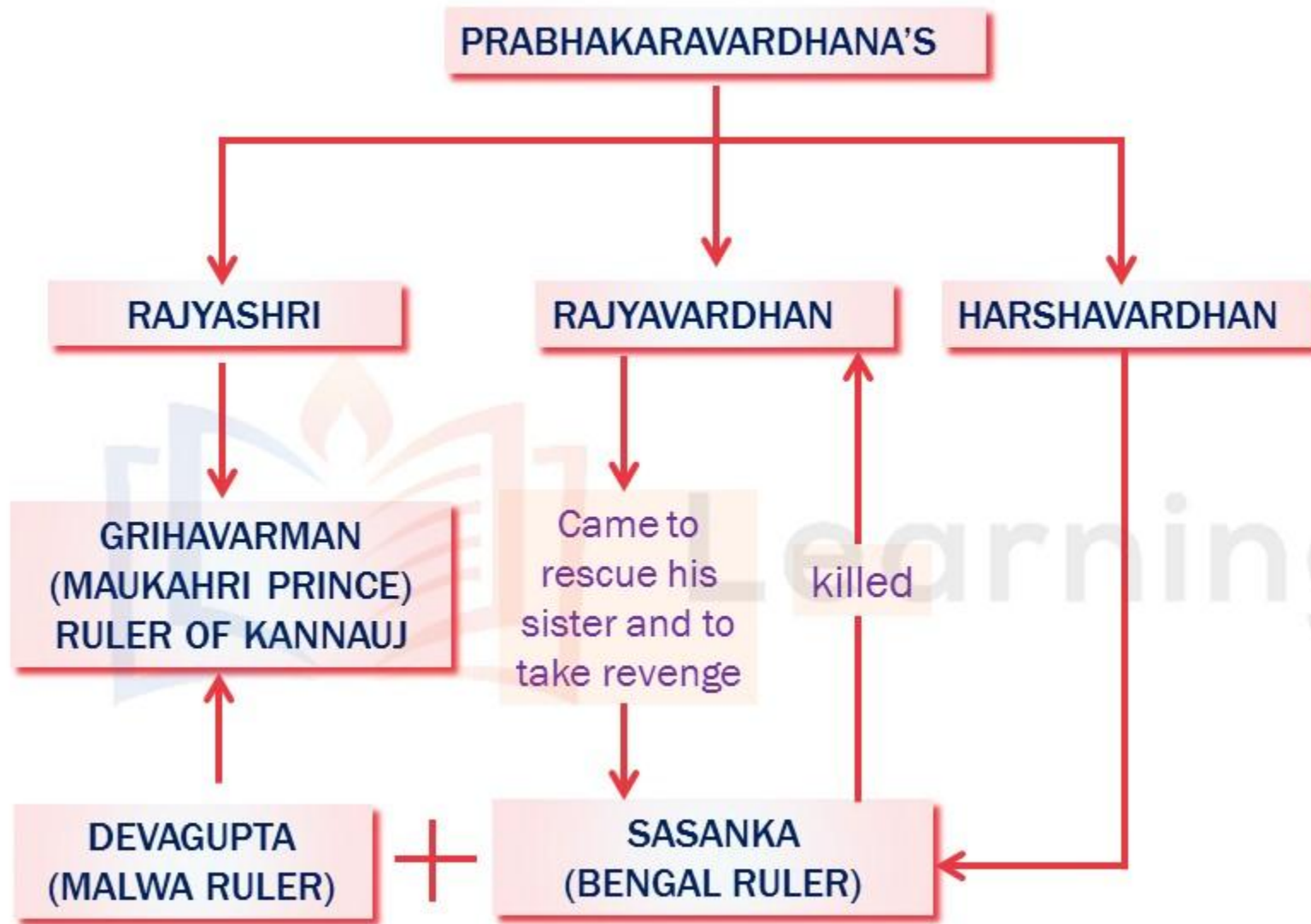
Now Harsha came to throne. His first responsibility was to rescue his sister who escaped to forest and to avenge the killings of his brother and brother-in-law.

6

Harsha traced her sister and brought her back. Later Harsha **annexed Sasanka kingdom**.

7

Since son of his sister was also an infant, **he annexed Kanauji** (capital of Mokharis) also to his empire.



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHAN AS A CONQUERER

Harsha dreamt of bringing India under “one umbrella”.

- Chalukyan king **Pulakeshin II** who effectively guarded the passes on Narmada River and prevented further advanced to south.
 - **Aihole inscription** of Pulakesin II mentions of the defeat of Harsha by Pulakesin.
 - Harsha later declared himself as *Uttarapathpathi* {lord of northern routes} while **Pulkesin-II** was declared as *Dakshinapathpathi*.
-
- The **last major attack** of Harsha was on **Ganjam coast** in 642-643AD.
 - However, after this conquest, **Harsha entered into a state of self-actualization** and then later part of his life was typically an imitation of Asoka.

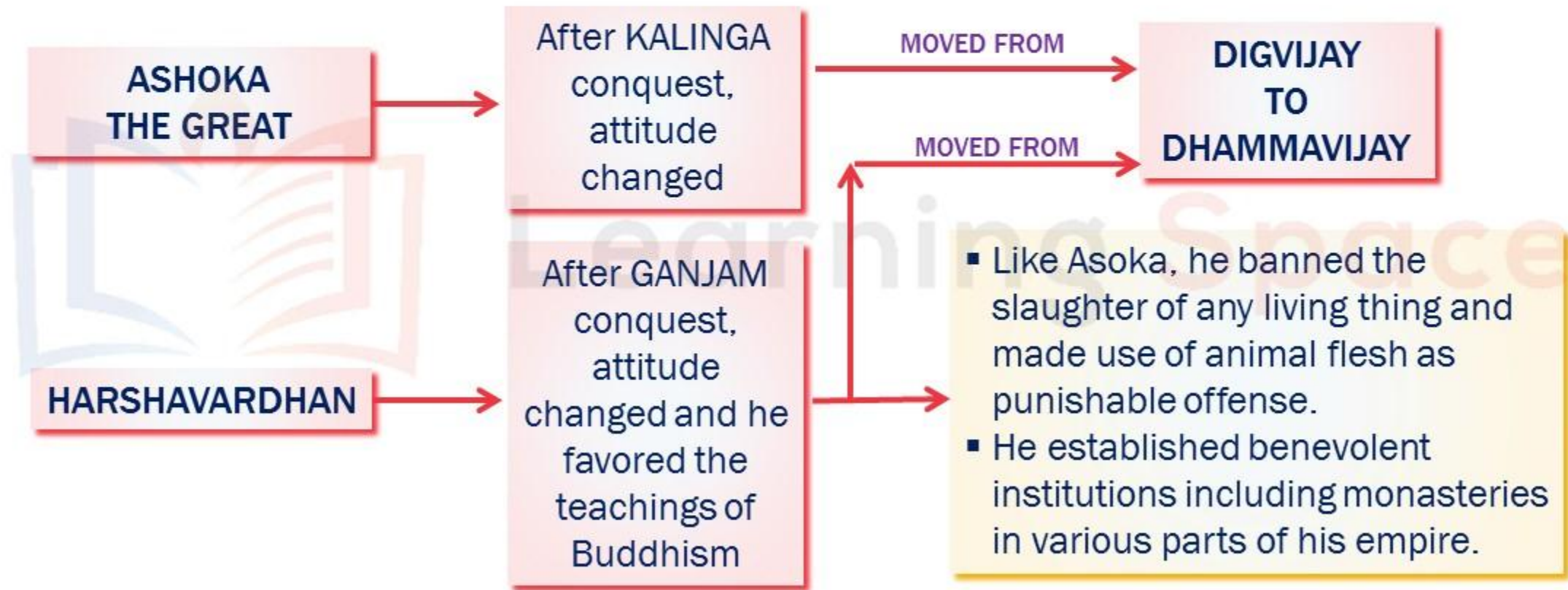
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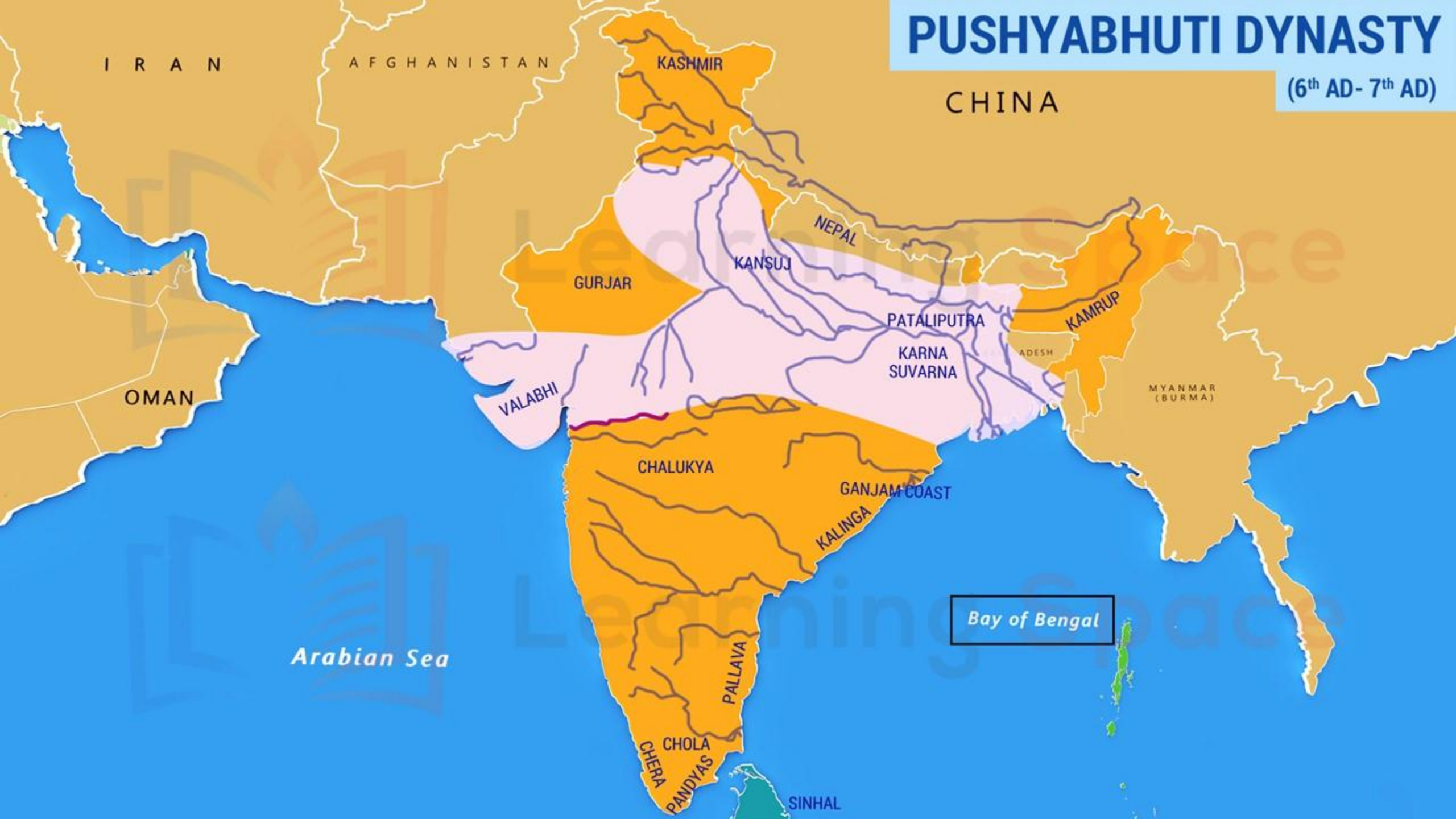
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ASHOKA- HARSHAVARDHAN



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(6th AD- 7th AD)



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

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HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHAN AS MAN OF INTELLECT

He was accomplished author and calligraphist and was a **great patron of art and culture.**



He has written three plays (dramas) viz.

- *Nagananda*,
- *Ratnavali* and
- *Priyadarsika*



In **Nagananda**, he depicted the story of Jimutvahana's self sacrifice to save the Nagas.

In **Ratnavali**, he has narrated story of a princess Ratnavali and king Udayana. It is considered the first textual reference of Holi celebration.

In **Priyadarshika** Love affair between king Udayana and Priyadarsika.

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HARSHAVARDHAN RELIGION

ON PERSONAL FRONT

Earlier he was devote of
shiva

Later he became ardent
Hinayana Buddhist.

Hiuen Tsang converted him
to **Mahayana Buddhism.**

ON SOCIAL FRONT HE CONVENED TWO ASSEMBLY

KANAUJ ASSEMBLY

Harsha organized a religious assembly at Kanauj to honour the Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang towards the close of his reign

PRAYAG ASSEMBLY

Assembly at Prayag began with worship of Surya, Shiva and Buddha. He used to donate full heartedly.

Despite is inclination towards Buddhism, Harsha was a great patron of all prevailing sects viz. Hinduism, Jainism and Buddhism.

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

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OBSERVATION OF HIUEN TSANG

OBJECTIVE



- 1 The key objective of Chinese Traveller Hiuen-Tsang to visit India was to correct the incomplete & misinterpreted information provided by the earlier Chinese monks, particularly Fa Hien.
- 2 In his work Si-Yu-Ki (Journey to the West), he first states that the name of India in China should be "Yindu". This term is still used in China for India.

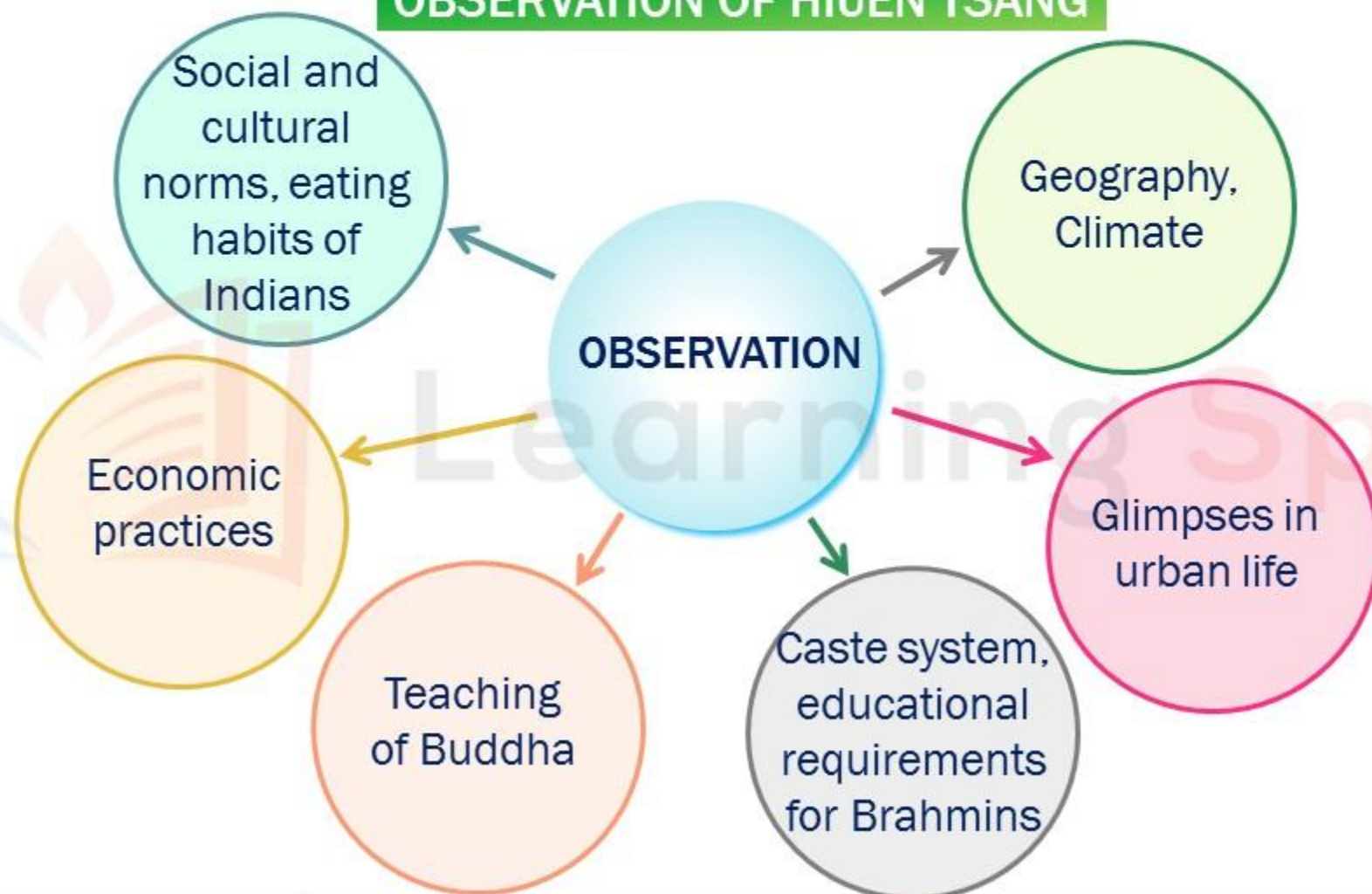
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OBSERVATION OF HIUEN TSANG



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

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OBSERVATION OF HIUEN TSANG ON HARSHA'S ADMINISTRATION

Land grants were in vogue.

TAXATION-was light- $1/6^{\text{th}}$ of produce.

There was a diplomatic relation between Harsha and Tang king of China.

King was just and punctual in his duties.

Administration was based on the Gupta model of decentralization

There were incidence of robbery as noted by Huein tsang, which we don't find in the narrations of Fa-Hien.

It might indicate a breakdown of administrative machinery in hinterlands of Harsha's empire.

ADMINISTRATION

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

OBSERVATION OF HIUEN TSANG

ON HARSHA'S ADMINISTRATION



- 1 Significant feature was maintenance of public records.
- 2 These archive were known as *nilopitu* and it was under the control of special officers.
- 3 Both good and bad events happened during his time had been recorded.

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